



UNIVERSAL HAPPINESS

What gives value to life is the happiness of the entire human race, not just individuals. This was the view of British philosopher Jeremy Bentham (1748–1832), who said the only correct way to act is for “the greatest good for the greatest number of people.” That means respecting everyone’s right to freedom and working to rid the world of poverty.



NATURE TRAIL

We have a responsibility to take care of our planet and all of the living things that exist here. This means doing everything we can to protect the natural environment so that it will still be there for future generations to enjoy. Human-made global warming is threatening Earth’s fragile ecosystems. Cool it before it’s too late.

“I’VE DISCOVERED THE SECRET OF LIFE—YOU JUST HANG AROUND UNTIL YOU GET USED TO IT.”

Sally Brown in “Peanuts,” a comic strip by Charles Schulz

NUMBER ONE

You won’t get anywhere in life if you don’t look out for number one. As Canadian rock musician Neil Peart (1952–) said, “Live for yourself—there’s no one else more worth living for.” It’s a brutal world out there, and the one thing you can be sure of is that no one else will do you any favors. Survival of the fittest is what counts in the human jungle.



ULTIMATE ANSWER

According to comedy science-fiction novel *The Hitchhiker’s Guide to the Galaxy* by Douglas Adams (1952–2001), the “Answer to the Ultimate Question of Life, the Universe, and Everything” is the number 42. It took a super-computer seven and a half million years of calculations to reach this answer, but everyone had forgotten what the question was. Oops!

